
PAPERBOY

TUESDAY, AUGUST 18, 2026

Nvidia agreed to guarantee the lease and power payments behind OpenAI's eight-gigawatt Ohio campus, putting the chipmaker's balance sheet underneath its own biggest customer.

AI

Anthropic's revenue run-rate hits \$65bn, on Bloomberg's word alone

WHAT HAPPENED

Anthropic's annualised revenue reached \$65bn at the end of July, up from \$47bn in May and roughly \$9bn at the close of 2025, [Axios reports](#), citing Bloomberg. Axios adds quarterly figures: \$4.73bn in Q1 2026, \$11.5bn in Q2. OpenAI is at about \$40bn on the same reporting. The Financial Times separately puts investor expectations for Anthropic's exit-2026 run-rate at \$100bn to \$120bn. Every outlet carrying the \$65bn traces back to the same Bloomberg story, and [Anthropic's own newsroom](#) says nothing about revenue or a listing. A search of SEC EDGAR turns up no public S-1 — only a Form D from 24 February. The June confidential-draft filing remains the only thing on the record.

WHAT IT MEANS

Treat the number as a leak, not a disclosure. It is the sort of figure a company lets out when it is setting expectations ahead of a listing, and the fact that it arrives unattributed is itself information. Axios flags that Anthropic and OpenAI may not count revenue the same way, so the league-table comparison is softer than it looks.

WATCH NEXT

A public S-1 on EDGAR is the moment any of this becomes checkable.

Alibaba sells its games studio for up to \$2bn to pour more into AI

WHAT HAPPENED

Alibaba sold Lingxi Games, maker of *Three Kingdoms: Strategy Edition*, to private-equity firm Trustar Capital for \$1.5bn to \$2bn, exiting in-house game development entirely, [Fortune reports](#). Lingxi chief executive Zhou Bingshu said the sale lets the business "better focus on its strategic priorities". The proceeds feed a three-year, \$53bn AI and cloud infrastructure commitment and a target of \$100bn in AI revenue by 2031. Alibaba's open-weight Qwen models logged 3 billion downloads in the past six months. Analyst Rui Ma called the move "cleaning up non-core assets, making returns higher".

WHAT IT MEANS

China's platform giants are doing what the American ones did two years ago — selling anything that is not compute or models to fund the things that are. Researcher Usha Haley notes the added incentive in China: capital directed at sectors Beijing has named strategic tends to be capital that stays out of trouble.

WATCH NEXT

Alibaba's September quarter results, and whether the cloud unit's capex guidance moves with the proceeds.

Nvidia becomes the guarantor of its own demand at OpenAI's Ohio megasite

WHAT HAPPENED

Nvidia is investing \$1.5bn in SB Energy, the SoftBank-affiliated developer of the Ports-Pike campus in Pike County, southern Ohio, and will be the site's [exclusive compute supplier](#) under a 20-year agreement. [OpenAI has signed on](#) for an initial 4.25 IT-gigawatts with an option on 3.75 more, backed by at least 10GW of new generation and over \$4.2bn of regional grid investment. First capacity — 800MW — lands in 2028, with phases running to 2030 and 35,000 construction jobs through 2032. Nvidia's release describes guaranteeing "defined portions of lease and power payments, along with a specified residual-value commitment". It publishes no total; reporters briefed by the company [put it at roughly \\$105bn](#), while DataCenterDynamics has heard about \$120bn, cut from a planned \$250bn. The site is a decommissioned uranium-enrichment plant.

WHAT IT MEANS

The chip vendor is now underwriting the lease payments of its largest customer's landlord. Asked whether that is circular financing, Jensen Huang told Axios: "Is this circular financing? No. OpenAI will pay the lease." Both things can be true — the revenue is real and the risk has quietly moved onto Nvidia's balance sheet. That the company will not publish the guarantee's size is the part worth noting.

WATCH NEXT

Nvidia's Q3 10-Q for how the residual-value commitment is disclosed.

Groq halves its valuation and starts reselling Nvidia

WHAT HAPPENED

Groq closed \$350m at a \$3.5bn valuation, led by Disruptive, [the company said](#) — down from \$6.9bn set in a \$750m round in September 2025. Nvidia's participation is described as planned, not closed; several outlets have overstated it. Groq now sells inference capacity on Nvidia hardware as a "neocloud" rather than shipping its own LPU chips, a pivot that began after founder Jonathan Ross and president Sunny Madra [left for Nvidia in December 2025](#) under a licensing deal. It runs 13 data centres and plans to grow from 54MW to over 200MW by 2027, after raising \$650m in June.

WHAT IT MEANS

The most-funded American challenger to Nvidia's inference position has become one of its customers. Groq disputes the down-round framing, arguing \$3.5bn prices the post-licensing company rather than the old one — which is fair, and also concedes the point. For anyone pricing used accelerators, it says the merchant-silicon alternative just got thinner.

WATCH NEXT

Whether Nvidia's stake actually closes, and at what size.

Paramount wants 12 state AGs to post a \$1.9bn bond for blocking its Warner deal

WHAT HAPPENED

Paramount Skydance asked a federal court on 17 August to require the plaintiffs holding up its \$110bn takeover of Warner Bros. Discovery — twelve state attorneys general and the Writers Guild of America — to [post a \\$1.9bn bond](#) against the cost of the delay. Paramount's arithmetic: after 30 September it owes WBD shareholders a "ticking fee" of 25 cents per share per quarter, about \$650m a quarter. Its filing argues that "federal law expressly provide that plaintiffs are required to post a bond covering the potential harm from halting a transaction". The states sued on antitrust grounds in July; a judge issued a temporary restraining order mid-month.

WHAT IT MEANS

This is a pressure tactic aimed at the plaintiffs' budgets rather than their arguments. State AGs do not carry \$1.9bn of bonding capacity, and the WGA certainly does not. If it works even partially it becomes a template for every large deal facing a state-level challenge.

WATCH NEXT

The court's ruling on the bond motion, and 30 September, when the ticking fee starts.

The ECB's chief economist calls 3% inflation "too high"

WHAT HAPPENED

Philip Lane, speaking in Ireland on 18 August, said euro-area inflation at 3% "remains too high", [arguing](#) that while 3% looks modest next to 2022's double digits, the distance from the ECB's 2% target is a real policy deviation rather than a rounding error. Bloomberg's headline on the same remarks says he expects inflation to hover near 3% for the rest of the year; that page could not be fetched, so treat the year-end projection as thinly sourced. The "too high" quote is confirmed.

WHAT IT MEANS

Read it as the ECB talking markets out of an autumn cut. Lane is the staff economist whose framing usually previews the Governing Council's, and "too high" is not the vocabulary of a central bank preparing to ease.

WATCH NEXT

The 10 September Governing Council meeting, and August flash HICP on 1 September.

Unitree lists tomorrow at \$9bn while Shein raises at a quarter of its old price

WHAT HAPPENED

Unitree Robotics trades on Shanghai's STAR Market on 19 August, raising RMB 6.1bn (about \$904m) at roughly \$9bn, with retail tranches [8,000 times oversubscribed](#). Its 2025 revenue was RMB 1.7bn (\$252m), four times 2024, on RMB 600m (\$89m) of net income, with about 45% of sales overseas. Shein is meanwhile targeting up to \$3bn in Hong Kong at a \$25bn-\$30bn valuation — against \$64bn in 2024 and \$100bn in 2022 — on \$41.2bn of 2025 revenue. Europe is Shein's largest market at 35.4% of revenue. Chinese firms shipped 97% of humanoid robots in the first half of 2026.

WHAT IT MEANS

Two Chinese listings, one week, opposite directions: the market will pay 35 times revenue for robots and less than one times revenue for fast fashion. Shein's European exposure makes its repricing a read on EU consumer regulation as much as on demand.

WATCH NEXT

Unitree's first print on 19 August — ignore gray-market implied prices, they are not trades.

Higgsfield raises \$400m at \$5.4bn, quadrupling in eight months

WHAT HAPPENED

AI video startup Higgsfield closed a \$400m Series B at a \$5.4bn valuation on 17 August, [the company announced](#), up from \$1.3bn at its January Series A. DST Global led, with an unusually transatlantic list behind it: Intel Capital, Liberty Global Ventures, NTT DOCOMO Ventures, Mirae Asset, Goldman Sachs Alternatives, Tribe, Fifth Wall and Valor, plus returning backers Accel and Menlo. Company-provided metrics: \$700m annualised revenue, 30 million users, 390 Fortune 500 customers. Founder Alex Mashrabov, formerly of Snap, [told TechCrunch](#) that "video is one of the most compute-intensive domains in AI", putting a minute of video at the processing equivalent of 60,000 words.

WHAT IT MEANS

None of the revenue figures are audited, and generative-video retention is the open question in the category. What is verifiable is the cap table: strategic money from a chipmaker, a cable group and a Japanese carrier suggests distribution deals as much as financial return.

WATCH NEXT

Whether any of the strategics announce a bundling deal — that would be the real signal.

Relay shuts down and its founder takes over product for Chrome

WHAT HAPPENED

Relay, the AI workflow-automation platform launched in 2021 as a Zapier rival, is winding down. Free users [lost access on 15 August](#); paying customers lose it on 14 September. Founder and chief executive Jacob Bank is joining Google as vice-president of product for Chrome, running product and developer relations, with some of his staff moving with him. Bank said he has "spent my whole career doing one thing: building tools that help people get more done with AI", calling Chrome "an ideal opportunity to bring those experiences to many, many more people". He spent six years at Google from 2015 after it bought his scheduling app Timeful. Capital raised, investors and deal terms were not disclosed.

WHAT IT MEANS

An acqui-hire with the acquisition removed — the team lands, the product dies, and investors get nothing they would put in a newsletter. Expect more of these: agentic workflow tools sit exactly where the model vendors and the browsers are both expanding.

WATCH NEXT

14 September, when paying customers need somewhere else to be.

Also raised

WHAT HAPPENED

Voice-interface company Wispr raised \$280m at a \$2bn valuation as it pushes past dictation, and Terra Industries closed a \$52m seed to build defence infrastructure for the Global South, [both per TechCrunch](#). These are headline-level only — neither article was fetched in full for this brief, so treat the figures as reported rather than verified.

WHAT IT MEANS

Two more datapoints in the same pattern as Higgsfield: application-layer AI companies raising growth-sized rounds at seed-and-A-stage maturity.

WATCH NEXT

Whether either publishes revenue alongside the valuation. Neither has.

Supreme Court closes the E. Jean Carroll case for good

WHAT HAPPENED

The Supreme Court denied Trump's petition for rehearing in [docket 25-573](#) on 17 August, the second time it has turned him away after denying certiorari on 29 June. The order carries no explanation, which is standard. The May 2023 jury verdict found him liable for sexual abuse and defamation and awarded \$5m; the roughly \$5.8m owed with interest was [released from escrow on 13 July](#) and has already been paid. Carroll's lawyer Roberta Kaplan said "the jury's unanimous verdict that Donald Trump sexually assaulted and then defamed E Jean Carroll is now final". A separate \$83.3m defamation verdict from January 2024 remains live: Trump filed a second cert petition on 28 July arguing presidential immunity covers statements made in office.

WHAT IT MEANS

The first case is over — no further avenue exists. The second is the one that matters legally, because it asks the Court to extend immunity to a president's own words about a private citizen.

WATCH NEXT

The Court's conference schedule this autumn for the \$83.3m petition.

Trump threatens to bomb Oman; Kaine will file a war powers resolution

WHAT HAPPENED

In a Fox News phone interview with Trey Yingst on 17 August, Trump said that if Oman gets in the way of reopening the Strait of Hormuz, "we'll bomb the shit out of them". Speaking to reporters the same day he said "I don't think they've behaved very well, but we'd handle them very easily, just like we do other things". Oman is a US ally and the main mediator between Washington and Tehran. Senator Tim Kaine [said he will file a war powers resolution](#) barring military action against Oman "as soon as we return from August recess". Representative Ro Khanna [told Axios](#): "At this point we may just need to file war powers resolutions for the 192 other countries." The 60-day Iran deadline expired on 17 August without a deal.

WHAT IT MEANS

Threatening the mediator removes the channel through which any settlement would have to pass. The congressional response is real but slow — the Senate is in recess until 11 September, so no vote can happen before then.

WATCH NEXT

The Senate's return on 11 September, and whether Kaine's resolution draws Republican co-sponsors.

Florida votes today, with Rubio's old Senate seat on the ballot

WHAT HAPPENED

Florida holds primaries on 18 August; polls had not closed at the time of writing. Representative Byron Donalds, Trump-endorsed, is favoured in the Republican gubernatorial primary against Lieutenant Governor Jay Collins, former House Speaker Paul Renner and businessman James Fishback; David Jolly is expected to take the Democratic nomination, [per Al Jazeera](#). The special election for Marco Rubio's Senate seat pits Republican Ashley Moody against a Democratic field including whistleblower Alexander Vindman and progressive Angie Nixon. In the House races, Randy Fine faces internet personality Dan Bilzerian, whose antisemitic campaign video drew a joint statement from Jewish members of Congress saying it "has no place in America".

WHAT IT MEANS

The governor's primary is the more consequential of the two — DeSantis won re-election by 19 points in 2022 after under one point in 2018, so the Republican nominee starts as the favourite in November.

WATCH NEXT

Results tonight; the general election is 3 November.

Russia sacks the state-bank economist who said the war cannot be won

WHAT HAPPENED

Andrey Klepach, chief economist of state development bank VEB.RF since 2014, has been removed. The story was broken on 16 August by [The Bell](#), an independent Russian exile outlet, citing insiders who said VEB head Igor Shuvalov acted on an order "from above". TASS, the state agency, later confirmed only that Klepach no longer holds the post, giving no reason; Klepach confirmed the dismissal to Reuters. The trigger was a May speech at the Moscow Exchange's Nikitsky Club that began circulating around 14 August, in which he said "We are falling behind. We are losing both the technological and economic competition in the world" and "We will not win the competition in this war of attrition", [per the Kyiv Independent](#).

WHAT IT MEANS

Firing a sitting state-bank economist for arithmetic is a legible signal about what can and cannot be said inside the Russian system. It also confirms the argument exists inside the system — Klepach was not a dissident, he was the man paid to model the economy.

WATCH NEXT

Whether VEB names a replacement, and how the September budget handles defence spending.

Allies who won't back the Iran campaign are losing troops and drills

WHAT HAPPENED

Axios [reports a pattern](#) of retaliation against allies declining to support the Iran campaign. Trump ordered "substantial" cuts to the Ulchi Freedom Shield exercises with South Korea after Seoul declined to join denuclearisation efforts; the Pentagon pulled about 5,000 troops from Germany in May after Chancellor Friedrich Merz criticised the Iran strategy; and Trump threatened total trade cutoffs against Spain after Madrid denied base access, with an unnamed Pentagon official said to have floated suspending Spain from NATO. The Pentagon has circulated surveys asking allies whether they have "shown alignment" with his foreign policy. Separately, the carrier USS George Washington is being pulled from the Pacific to relieve the USS Abraham Lincoln, [leaving Asia temporarily without one](#).

WHAT IT MEANS

The NATO-suspension line rests on a single unnamed official and should be read as a leak, not a policy. The troop movements and drill cuts are not in dispute, and they are the more consequential fact: alliance commitments are being priced against a single regional campaign.

WATCH NEXT

Whether Ulchi Freedom Shield proceeds at reduced scale, and the NATO defence ministers' meeting this autumn.

Likud picks its slate on 53% turnout as Gaza disarmament plan shifts

WHAT HAPPENED

Israel's Likud primary closed on 17 August with 53% turnout, low by the party's standards, though Haredi voters reportedly turned out in numbers, [per the Times of Israel liveblog](#). The vote sets Likud's Knesset slate ahead of general elections on 27 October. Separately, the Board of Peace is weighing a revised Gaza framework after Israeli objections to phased withdrawals: one unnamed source says "the entire area currently under Hamas's control would be decommissioned of weapons all at once, rather than sector by sector" — one source in a liveblog, so unconfirmed. Jared Kushner predicted movement on Hamas disarmament "in as little as 30 days". A Channel 12 poll found the opposition bloc reaching a 63-seat majority if retired general Ofer Winter forms a right-wing party and joins it.

WHAT IT MEANS

The all-at-once framing is the harder ask, and moving to it after Israeli pushback suggests the mediators are optimising for Netanyahu's signature rather than for feasibility. The Channel 12 number is the more durable fact: Likud is heading into October with a plausible path to losing.

WATCH NEXT

The Likud slate results, and 27 October.

SOURCES

[Nvidia — Ports-Pike campus release](#)

[OpenAI — joining the Ports-Pike project](#)

[Axios — Nvidia, OpenAI and the Ohio data centre](#)

[Groq — \\$350m Series A](#)

[TechCrunch — Groq's pivot to neocloud](#)

[Axios — Anthropic revenue run-rate](#)

[Fortune — Anthropic's \\$65bn run-rate](#)

[Fortune — Alibaba sells Lingxi Games](#)

[Axios — Paramount seeks \\$1.9bn bond](#)

[ECB's Lane on euro-area inflation](#)

[Fortune — Unitree vs Shein](#)

[Higgsfield — \\$400m Series B](#)

[TechCrunch — Relay shuts down](#)

[Supreme Court — docket 25-573](#)

[SCOTUSblog — rehearing denied in Carroll](#)

[Sen. Kaine — war powers resolution on Oman](#)

[Axios — Trump, Oman and war powers](#)

[Al Jazeera — Florida primary preview](#)

[Moscow Times — Klepach dismissed](#)

[Kyiv Independent — Klepach's warning](#)

[Axios — allies and the Iran campaign](#)

[Times of Israel — 17 August liveblog](#)